

WOMEN & YOUTH EMPOWERMENT

Creating Opportunity. Building Confidence. Strengthening Communities.

Overview

Women and young people are among the most important drivers of social and economic development. Yet, in many rural and underserved communities, they continue to face barriers that limit their access to education, skills, employment, healthcare, entrepreneurship, leadership and meaningful participation in society.

Women often experience financial dependency, limited livelihood opportunities, social inequality and inadequate awareness of health and rights. At the same time, many young people face unemployment, limited career guidance, lack of market-relevant skills and restricted access to opportunities that can help them build sustainable futures.

These challenges can result in:

- Limited access to education and skill development
- Unemployment and underemployment among youth
- Financial dependency among women
- Limited opportunities for entrepreneurship and self-employment
- Early school dropout and restricted career pathways
- Low awareness of health, hygiene, rights and available opportunities
- Limited participation in community decision-making
- Migration caused by lack of local opportunities
- Loss of confidence and underutilisation of individual potential

ISLAH believes that **empowering women and youth is not simply about helping—it is about creating pathways to capability, dignity, independence and participation.**

Through integrated initiatives in education, skills, livelihoods, entrepreneurship, awareness and community engagement, ISLAH seeks to help women and young people become more confident, capable and economically active members of their communities.

Our Objective

To empower women and youth by creating opportunities for **education, skills, livelihoods, entrepreneurship, financial awareness, leadership and meaningful community participation**, enabling them to achieve greater self-reliance and contribute to sustainable community development.

Our Approach

1. Education & Awareness

Promoting access to knowledge and awareness that can help women and young people make informed decisions about education, careers, health, rights and opportunities.

2. Skills & Employability

Supporting practical and market-relevant skills that can improve employability, self-employment and livelihood opportunities.

3. Entrepreneurship & Livelihoods

Encouraging women and youth to explore entrepreneurship, micro-enterprises, self-employment and other sustainable income opportunities.

4. Financial Awareness & Independence

Promoting financial literacy, savings awareness, income-generation capabilities and greater economic independence.

5. Leadership & Participation

Creating opportunities for women and youth to participate in community activities, leadership initiatives, volunteering and local development processes.

6. Rights, Dignity & Inclusion

Promoting awareness of rights, gender equality, dignity and inclusive participation while supporting vulnerable individuals through appropriate programmes.

Key Initiatives

ISLAH aims to develop and implement initiatives such as:

01-Women Skill Development & Livelihood Programme

Supporting women with practical skills and livelihood opportunities that can contribute to greater economic independence.

02-Self-Help Group Capacity Building

Strengthening knowledge, skills and organisational capacity among women participating in community-based groups.

03-Women's Rights & Gender Equality Awareness

Creating awareness regarding dignity, equality, rights and participation in family and community life.

04-Youth Career & Entrepreneurship Development

Encouraging career planning, entrepreneurship, innovation and self-employment among rural youth.

Learn → Develop Skills → Build Confidence → Empower

Expected Impact

Through its Women & Youth Empowerment initiatives, ISLAH aims to contribute towards:

- Improved access to skills and livelihood opportunities
- Increased employability and self-employment
- Greater financial independence among women
- Increased participation of women in economic activities
- Improved career awareness and preparedness among youth
- Growth of entrepreneurship and small-scale enterprises
- Increased confidence, leadership and decision-making capacity
- Greater awareness of health, rights and social responsibilities
- Reduced dependence on unsustainable or low-income livelihoods
- Increased participation in community development
- Stronger and more resilient families and communities

Our Vision

ISLAH envisions communities where **every woman and young person can learn, develop skills, earn with dignity, participate meaningfully and shape a better future.**

We believe that when women and youth gain **knowledge, capability, confidence and opportunity**, the benefits extend beyond individuals to families, communities and future generations.

“Empowering women and youth with knowledge, skills, dignity and opportunity-building confident individuals, stronger families and resilient communities.”

ISLAH

Women Skill Development & Livelihood Programme

Building Skills. Creating Livelihoods. Strengthening Women's Independence.

The **Women Skill Development & Livelihood Programme** is an ISLAH initiative designed to help women in rural and underserved communities develop practical skills, access livelihood opportunities, and build sustainable sources of income.

Many women possess talent, determination and the willingness to work, but lack access to structured training, market exposure, financial awareness and opportunities to convert their abilities into meaningful livelihoods. ISLAH seeks to bridge this gap by creating a supportive pathway from **learning and skill development to livelihood, entrepreneurship and self-reliance**.

Our Approach

The programme focuses on practical, locally relevant and income-oriented skills that can create opportunities for employment, self-employment and home-based enterprises.

1. Skill Development

Training in practical and market-relevant skills based on local needs, interests and opportunities.

2. Livelihood Readiness

Helping women understand how their skills can be converted into employment, services, home-based work or small enterprises.

3. Entrepreneurship Development

Building basic entrepreneurial capabilities, including business planning, costing, pricing, customer understanding and enterprise management.

4. Financial & Digital Awareness

Promoting financial literacy, digital confidence, responsible money management and awareness of available financial and livelihood opportunities.

5. Market & Business Linkages

Where feasible, connecting trained women with local markets, customers, institutions, businesses, self-help groups and other livelihood networks.

6. Mentorship & Continued Support

Providing guidance and mentorship to help women apply their skills, overcome initial challenges and progressively strengthen their livelihood activities.

Implementation Approach

Depending on local needs and available resources, training may include:

- Tailoring & garment making
- Handicrafts and traditional products
- Beauty & wellness services
- Home-based production
- Digital literacy and basic computer skills
- Retail and service-based skills
- Small business and enterprise skills
- Other locally relevant income-generating activities

Who We Aim to Support

The programme primarily focuses on:

- Rural women and girls

- Women from economically vulnerable households
- Women seeking employment or self-employment
- Women interested in home-based livelihoods
- Aspiring women entrepreneurs
- Women seeking to strengthen existing small livelihood activities

The ISLAH Livelihood Pathway

LEARN → DEVELOP → PREPARE → START → EARN → GROW

We believe that meaningful empowerment begins when a woman has the knowledge and skills to make choices, the confidence to take action, and the opportunity to earn with dignity.

Expected Impact

Through this programme, ISLAH aims to contribute towards:

- Greater access to practical and market-relevant skills
- Improved employability and livelihood readiness
- Increased opportunities for self-employment
- Growth of women-led micro-enterprises
- Improved financial and digital awareness
- Greater participation of women in household and community economic life
- Increased confidence, dignity and economic independence

Our Vision

To create an enabling environment where women—particularly in rural and underserved communities—can **learn, earn, participate and progress with dignity and confidence.**

“A skill can become an opportunity. An opportunity can become a livelihood. And a livelihood can become independence.”

Self-Help Group Capacity Building

Strengthening Groups. Building Confidence. Creating Collective Opportunity.

Overview

The **Self-Help Group (SHG) Capacity Building Initiative** is an ISLAH programme designed to strengthen women-led and community-based groups by developing their organisational, financial, leadership and livelihood capabilities.

Self-Help Groups can become powerful platforms for collective action, savings, livelihood development and community participation. However, many groups need continued guidance and capacity building to strengthen their internal systems, manage resources effectively, access opportunities and develop sustainable income-generating activities.

ISLAH seeks to support SHGs with practical knowledge, mentoring and community-level capacity building so that groups can become **more organised, confident, responsible and self-reliant.**

Our Approach

1. Group Formation & Strengthening

Promoting awareness of collective action, group participation, shared responsibility and effective functioning of SHGs.

2. Leadership & Governance

Building leadership capabilities, participatory decision-making, role clarity, meeting practices and transparent group processes.

3. Financial Literacy & Record Management

Developing basic knowledge of savings, financial planning, record keeping, budgeting and responsible management of group funds.

4. Livelihood & Enterprise Development

Helping SHGs explore practical livelihood and micro-enterprise opportunities based on members' skills, local resources and market demand.

5. Digital & Financial Inclusion

Improving awareness of digital tools, banking services, digital payments and other relevant financial and livelihood services.

6. Market & Institutional Linkages

Where feasible, facilitating connections with markets, financial institutions, government schemes, businesses, training providers and other support organisations.

7. Mentorship & Continuous Capacity Building

Providing ongoing guidance and learning opportunities to help groups address challenges, improve their functioning and strengthen sustainability.

Implementation Approach

- Leadership
- Governance
- Financial Literacy
- Record Keeping
- Livelihoods
- Entrepreneurship
- Digital Skills

Who We Aim to Support

The initiative may support:

- Women-led Self-Help Groups
- Emerging community-based groups
- Rural women seeking collective livelihood opportunities
- SHGs involved in savings and income-generating activities
- Women aspiring to develop micro-enterprises
- Community groups requiring organisational and financial capacity building

Expected Impact

Through this initiative, ISLAH aims to contribute towards:

- Stronger and better-organised SHGs
- Improved leadership and decision-making
- Greater financial awareness and accountability
- Better record-keeping and group management
- Increased livelihood and enterprise opportunities
- Improved digital and financial capability
- Stronger market and institutional connections

- Greater confidence and collective participation among women

The ISLAH SHG Development Pathway

ORGANISE → LEARN → STRENGTHEN → COLLABORATE → CREATE → GROW

Our approach is designed to help SHGs progress from **collective participation to stronger institutions and sustainable livelihood opportunities**.

Our Vision

To strengthen Self-Help Groups as **inclusive platforms for learning, collective action, economic opportunity and community development**, enabling rural women to build stronger livelihoods and greater self-reliance.

“When women come together, collective strength becomes collective opportunity.”

Part of Women & Youth Empowerment

ISLAH

Women’s Rights & Gender Equality Awareness

Know Your Rights. Strengthen Your Voice. Build a More Equal Future.

The **Women’s Rights & Gender Equality Awareness Initiative** is an ISLAH programme focused on creating awareness about women’s rights, dignity, equality, safety and meaningful participation in family and community life.

In many rural and underserved communities, women may have limited awareness of their legal and social rights or face barriers to education, decision-making, economic participation and access to support systems. ISLAH seeks to address these gaps through **rights awareness, community dialogue, education and appropriate referral support**.

Our Approach

1. Rights & Legal Awareness

Creating accessible awareness of basic rights, entitlements and legal protections relevant to women and girls.

2. Gender Equality & Social Awareness

Encouraging positive attitudes towards equal opportunities, dignity, respect and participation of women and girls.

3. Awareness on Safety & Protection

Promoting awareness about violence, harassment, exploitation and available avenues for seeking appropriate help and support.

4. Education & Empowerment

Encouraging women and girls to understand the importance of education, confidence, informed decision-making and participation in community life.

5. Community Dialogue

Engaging families, community members, youth and local stakeholders in constructive conversations around dignity, equality, respect and shared responsibility.

6. Access to Information & Referral

Where appropriate, helping individuals become aware of relevant government services, legal-aid mechanisms and support institutions, with referrals to qualified or authorised service providers where required.

Who We Aim to Reach

The initiative may focus on:

- Rural women and girls
- Adolescent girls and young women
- Women from vulnerable households
- Families and community members
- Youth and community leaders
- Local groups and community-based organisations

Expected Impact

ISLAH aims to contribute towards:

- Greater awareness of women's rights and legal protections
- Increased confidence to seek information and appropriate support
- Greater understanding of gender equality
- More positive community attitudes towards women and girls
- Increased participation of women in household and community decision-making
- Stronger awareness of available support and referral mechanisms
- Greater dignity, inclusion and social participation

Our Community Awareness Pathway

INFORM → UNDERSTAND → SPEAK → PARTICIPATE → EMPOWER

We believe that awareness is the first step towards meaningful empowerment. When women understand their rights and communities understand their responsibilities, **equality becomes a shared commitment rather than an individual struggle.**

Our Vision

To contribute towards rural communities where **women and girls are informed, respected, safe, heard and able to participate equally in shaping their families, livelihoods and communities.**

“Equality begins with awareness, grows through participation and becomes meaningful when every woman can live with dignity.”

ISLAH

Youth Career & Entrepreneurship Development

Discover Direction. Build Capability. Create Opportunity.

Overview

The **Youth Career & Entrepreneurship Development Programme** is an ISLAH initiative designed to help young people in rural and underserved communities make informed career choices, develop entrepreneurial thinking and build pathways towards meaningful employment, self-employment and sustainable livelihoods.

For many young people, choosing a career can be difficult without access to reliable information, professional guidance, mentors, exposure to different career pathways and practical knowledge about entrepreneurship. ISLAH seeks to bridge this gap by connecting **career awareness with skills, mentorship and enterprise development**.

Our Objective

The programme aims to help young people move from uncertainty to informed action—understanding their strengths, exploring opportunities, developing relevant capabilities and taking practical steps towards their chosen career or enterprise pathway.

Our Approach

1. Career Awareness & Exploration

Helping youth understand different education, training, employment and career pathways while encouraging them to identify their interests, strengths and aspirations.

2. Career Guidance & Planning

Supporting young people in setting realistic career goals and developing individual pathways towards further education, employment, skill development or entrepreneurship.

3. Entrepreneurship Orientation

Introducing entrepreneurial thinking and helping aspiring young entrepreneurs understand opportunities, business basics, innovation and responsible enterprise development.

4. Business Planning & Enterprise Skills

Building practical knowledge in areas such as idea development, business planning, costing, pricing, customer understanding, marketing and basic financial management.

5. Mentorship & Professional Exposure

Where feasible, connecting youth with professionals, entrepreneurs, educators and experienced mentors who can provide guidance, inspiration and practical perspectives.

6. Digital & Emerging Opportunities

Creating awareness of digital careers, technology-enabled work, online opportunities and emerging areas of employment and entrepreneurship.

7. Opportunity Linkages

Where feasible, facilitating connections with educational institutions, training providers, employers, businesses, entrepreneurship networks and other relevant opportunities.

Who We Aim to Support

- Rural and underserved youth
- School and college students
- Graduates and first-time job seekers
- Unemployed and underemployed youth
- Youth exploring career alternatives
- Aspiring young entrepreneurs
- Young people from economically vulnerable communities

Expected Impact

ISLAH aims to contribute towards:

- Greater career awareness and informed decision-making
- Improved understanding of education and employment pathways
- Stronger career planning capabilities
- Increased entrepreneurial awareness
- Better understanding of basic enterprise development

- Greater access to mentors and professional networks
- Improved confidence in pursuing career and livelihood goals
- Increased readiness for employment, self-employment and entrepreneurship

The ISLAH Youth Pathway

DISCOVER → EXPLORE → PLAN → DEVELOP → CREATE → PROGRESS

We believe young people need more than information—they need **direction, confidence, relevant capabilities and access to opportunity.**

Our Vision

To enable rural and underserved youth to make **informed career choices, develop entrepreneurial capabilities and build meaningful pathways towards employment, enterprise and sustainable livelihoods.**

“A clear direction can change a young person’s future; the right opportunity can help them build it.”

ISLAH